

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 9 8 6

♥ 8 7 4

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q

♠ A J 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 10 9 2

♣ 9 7 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q

♥ 10 9 6 5 2

♦ J 8 6 3

♣ 6 4 2

♠ 7 5 4 2

♥ K Q

♦ A 5

♣ K J 10 8 5

[showcards W:SQ N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠Q, a low card was played from dummy,

Play the ♠K.

It seems that perhaps you should play low and let partner's ♠Q force out North's ♠A. Then, when you get the lead with a high ♣ you can force out North's ♠J. Get the lead with your other high ♣ and set the contract with ♠s.

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♠      | 2NT   | Pass | 1 ♣   |
| All Pass |       |      | 3NT   |

3NT by North

The contract could no longer be beaten.

Suppose you try that. Play low on the first ♠. North will also play low and East will be left holding the trick, and also holding the bag! With no more ♠s East will have to play one of the other three suits, and that is just what North wants to have happen.

Now do it the right way. Play your ♠K on partner's ♠Q. Assume North takes the trick, although it doesn't matter whether he wins the first one or holds up. When you win your first ♣ drive out North's ♠J. When you win your second ♣ trick your ♠s will be good. If you overtake the first trick the contract can no longer be made.

Notice that North will always make two ♠ tricks, so your overtake costs nothing.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3  
 ♥ J 8 6 5 2  
 ♦ J 10 9 4  
 ♣ K 4

♠ A 6  
 ♥ K 9 3  
 ♦ Q 6 2  
 ♣ Q J 9 8 2



♠ K 8 7 5 4 2  
 ♥ Q 10 4  
 ♦ 8 3  
 ♣ A 6

♠ Q J 10  
 ♥ A 7  
 ♦ A K 7 5  
 ♣ 10 7 5 3

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♣    | 2♠   | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South

West (your wonderful partner) will win the first ♣ and return his final ♠ to dummy's ♠A.

South will have to keep working on ♣s, but now you can win the ♣A and play your ♠K, dropping South's ♠Q, and your other three good ♠s.

Just like the previous deal, South gets two ♠ tricks either way, but one way he makes an overtrick, the other way he goes down 2.

[showcards W:S9 N:S6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠9, dummy played the ♠6

Play the ♠8 (to signal encouragement).

You could easily win the ♠K, then play a small ♠ to drive out dummy's ♠A. But South bid Notrump over your 2♠ overcall, so he surely holds ♠ Q J 10. So when you get the lead with your one ♣A entry you can establish your ♠s, but you won't get into the lead to cash them.

Look what happens when you duck the first trick. South will win the trick with his ♠10, and start on dummy's ♣ suit.

**Board 5**

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 2  
 ♥ 8 4 3  
 ♦ 9 5 4  
 ♣ A 8 7 5 3

♠ K 9 5

♥ A K 9 7 5 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A Q 8 3

♥ 6

♦ J 10 7 2

♣ K Q J 10

♠ J 10 6 4

♥ Q J 10

♦ A K 6

♣ 9 4 2

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♥    | Dbl  | Rdbl  |
| 2♣       | Pass  | 3♣   | 3♥    |
| Pass     | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by North  
 next two ♠s, then leads a third ♠ for you to ruff. Down 1.

[showcards W:CK N:C2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣K, dummy played low

Overtake partner's ♣K with the ♣A.

You are pretty sure partner would not have supported your ♣s unless he had 4 of them, which means it is very likely that North has a singleton. (he might even be void)

So if you are to set this contract partner is going to have to have some ♠ winners. It might not matter, but it also might be vital that the first ♠ lead comes from your side of the table so after you overtake with the ♣A you switch to the ♠7.

Partner loves it - whatever North does East takes the